

SETI Update in China

Good Morning, everyone!

I'm Tongjie Zhang from China, and it is my great honor to have time to share SETI developments in China. Sincerely Thank the SETI committee and Mike for this meeting here!

Let me cover three parts: the national development program of China, SETI funding, and our SETI advances at FAST.

1. National Space Science Development Plan

Last October, the Chinese Academy of Sciences, China National Space Administration, and China Manned Space Engineering Office jointly released The Mid and Long-term National Space Science Development Plan (2024–2050). This landmark document outlines 5 key scientific themes and 17 priority areas. The fourth theme — and also the most critical one — is "Habitable Planets" (encompassing the Solar System and exoplanets).

Chinese scientists will explore the habitability of both the Solar System and exoplanets, as well as search for extraterrestrial life (including SETI).

Notably, this is the first time the Chinese government has officially announced the launch of the life beyond search. Thus, China's SETI efforts have finally received official support from the Chinese Government.

2. SETI Funding from the Chinese Government

Against this backdrop of reform, I secured funding support from the Ministry of Science and Technology of China in early 2025. It is the first SETI funding provided by the Chinese government — approximately 500,000 US dollars.

3. SETI Observations at FAST

We continued to conduct several SETI observations at FAST, including:

SETI backend and SETI observations of select globular clusters .

Currently, we are accelerating data processing! we are stepping up data processing, and I look forward to sharing interesting SETI results at next year's SETI meeting!

That's all for me! Thanks a lot!

